*Major drivers of this strong investment included further monetary loosening in the developed world, continued sovereign debt crisis, rising longer-term inflation fears and in key markets, negative real interest rates coupled with limited attractive risk-free investment alternatives to gold.*

*In 2012, the gold mine production increased by 12 MT to 2848 MT and the combined demand for bars & coins dropped from 1515 MT to 1256 MT.*

*Global Scenario*

*London is the world's biggest clearing house.*

*Mumbai is under India's liberalized gold regime.*

*New York is the home of gold futures trading.*

*Zurich is a physical turntable.*

*Istanbul, Dubai, Singapore, and Hong Kong are doorways to important consuming regions.*

*Tokyo, where TOCOM sets the mood of Japan.*